

DLRDMV v. Lease End

The complaint concerns competing automotive lease-buyout, title, and registration workflows. Public materials describe DLRdmv's platform as supporting state-specific fee calculation, compliant forms, electronic submissions, dealer-management-system integrations, title-brand checks, and related transaction data. The likely technical proof will turn on the precise information claimed as secret, how each platform implements those workflows, and whether access logs, repositories, integrations, and development history show use or independent development.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-18	N.D. Fla.	4:26-cv-00408	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	DLRDMV LLC v. Lease End LLC et al.
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FORUM / DOCKET	N.D. Fla. / 4:26-cv-00408
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-18 / trade secret
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

DLRdmv, LLC filed this Defend Trade Secrets Act and technically complex commercial action against Lease End, LLC, Tater, Inc., and Tater Finance, LLC on August 18, 2026 in the U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Florida, No. 4:26-cv-00408. The public RECAP complaint identifies the plaintiff's outside-counsel team and the docket source corroborates the caption, forum, filing date, parties, and docket number.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Matthew F. Prewitt - ArentFox Schiff LLP; named plaintiff counsel in the complaint signature block. The public complaint names Prewitt as counsel for DLRdmv and states that his pro hac vice filing was forthcoming; the public docket snapshot records an admission notice. Selecting him as a likely purchaser of technical expert research is an analytical inference from that role, not a statement about internal responsibility.

matthew.prewitt@afslaw.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

The complaint concerns competing automotive lease-buyout, title, and registration workflows. Public materials describe DLRdmv's platform as supporting state-specific fee calculation, compliant forms, electronic submissions, dealer-management-system integrations, title-brand checks, and related transaction data. The likely technical proof will turn on the precise information claimed as secret, how each platform implements those workflows, and whether access logs, repositories, integrations, and development history show use or independent development.

Secondary-source limitation: The complaint and public product materials frame the workflow categories, but they do not establish the final trade-secret definitions, source-code correspondence, alleged acquisition path, or causation. Any confidential trade-secret schedule, source code, repository history, logs, state-rule tables, integration specifications, and discovery responses must control the merits analysis. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Trade-secret identification and technical boundaries

Which source-code modules, rules tables, fee logic, form mappings, integration specifications, data models, security controls, or process documents are actually claimed as trade secrets, and are they technically separable from public law, vendor documentation, common industry practice, and customer-specific configuration?

Potential evidence: Complaint and any trade-secret schedule; architecture diagrams; source trees; database schemas; requirements and design documents; state manuals and forms; vendor APIs; customer agreements; versioned rules tables; and testimony from developers and implementation personnel.

02 End-to-end workflow architecture

How do the parties' systems move a lease-buyout or dealer transaction from intake through identity and vehicle checks, payoff information, fee calculation, document generation, signatures, funding, title work, registration, and status reporting?

Potential evidence: Service maps; API traces; message queues; database transactions; UI recordings; workflow engines; deployment diagrams; third-party service contracts; support runbooks; and representative transaction files.

03 State-specific fee and rules-engine implementation

How are taxes, title and registration fees, lien and payoff rules, jurisdictional exceptions, effective dates, and customer-specific charges represented, updated, tested, and applied, and which portions are dictated by public law rather than proprietary implementation?

Potential evidence: Rules tables; calculation code; state change logs; test suites; production outputs; fee reconciliations; error reports; release notes; and public state schedules.

04 Forms, compliance, and document-generation logic

How are state forms selected, populated, validated, versioned, signed, transmitted, and retained, and are allegedly similar outputs explained by mandatory forms and public filing requirements?

Potential evidence: Template repositories; field-mapping tables; validation code; form-version histories; e-signature and submission logs; rejected transaction records; and state agency specifications.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Dealer-management-system and third-party integration

Which data originate in dealer-management systems, lenders, valuation services, identity providers, motor-vehicle agencies, or other vendors; how are records normalized and reconciled; and which connectors or mappings are allegedly proprietary?

Potential evidence: API contracts; schemas; connector code; mapping tables; credentials; partner documentation; interface logs; retry and error handling; and vendor testimony.

06 Vehicle, title-brand, party, and transaction data quality

How are VINs, owners, lienholders, title brands, jurisdictions, addresses, and transaction identities matched, deduplicated, validated, and audited across inconsistent source systems?

Potential evidence: Data dictionaries; match and merge logic; confidence rules; exception queues; audit histories; sample records; false-positive and false-negative analyses; and external data-source specifications.

07 Access, acquisition, provenance, and independent development

What systems and repositories were accessible to the relevant people, what was copied or exported, when allegedly similar functionality appeared, and can repository, cloud, endpoint, and build evidence distinguish use from independent development?

Potential evidence: Git history; tickets; build artifacts; cloud and identity logs; downloads; endpoint images; communications; access-control changes; credential use; third-party repositories; and reproducible code and data comparisons.

08 Reasonable technical secrecy measures

Were authentication, least privilege, tenant isolation, encryption, logging, offboarding, repository controls, contractual access boundaries, monitoring, and incident response reasonably aligned with the alleged secrets and actual platform architecture?

Potential evidence: Identity architecture; role matrices; SSO and MFA records; repository permissions; audit logs; key management; vendor access; security policies; offboarding records; penetration tests; and incident files.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Michael Stonebraker

Adjunct Professor, MIT Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence Laboratory

TECHNICAL FIT

Database-system architecture, transaction processing, data models, scalable data systems, and automotive data platforms fit the rules tables, transaction records, integrations, provenance, and data-comparison questions in this matter.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT CSAIL identifies Stonebraker with its Data Systems Group and a project on building a scalable database for autonomous-vehicle data. He is a Turing Award recipient and the architect or co-founder behind multiple major database systems and companies.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed MIT profile and bounded public-web search did not identify a candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial record. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public work is database-centered rather than state title-and-registration operations, and his extensive database-company relationships require careful conflicts and commercial-interest diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | stonebraker@csail.mit.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Mark S. Fox

Professor Emeritus of Industrial Engineering and Computer Science and Distinguished Professor of Urban Systems Engineering, University of Toronto

TECHNICAL FIT

Enterprise integration, ontologies, common data models, workflow coordination, and knowledge representation fit DMS and government-system connectors, state-rule representation, and data ownership boundaries.

RELEVANT WORK

Founded the Enterprise Integration Laboratory; led the TOVE enterprise-ontology project; and has worked on distributed systems, scheduling, project management, simulation, engineering design, e-retail systems, and smart-city information models.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed University of Toronto profile and bounded public-web search did not identify a candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial record. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Emeritus status and a research emphasis on ontologies and smart cities may require pairing with a current automotive retail or source-code specialist.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | mark.fox@utoronto.ca | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Lise Getoor

Distinguished Professor and Jack Baskin Chair in Computer Engineering, University of California, Santa Cruz

TECHNICAL FIT

Entity resolution, record linkage, relational learning, information extraction, and data integration fit VIN, owner, lienholder, jurisdiction, title-brand, and transaction-record reconciliation.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads the LINQS laboratory and publishes on machine learning, databases, entity resolution, information extraction, and reasoning over connected data.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed UCSC directory and engineering profiles do not identify expert-testimony work. This is not proof that she has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Her research is stronger on data integration and relational learning than on motor-vehicle agency practice, fee rules, or production dealership software.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | getoor@ucsc.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Nenad Medvidovic

TRW Professor in Engineering and Professor and Chair of Computer Science, University of Southern California

TECHNICAL FIT

Software architecture, architecture recovery, distributed systems, software modernization, and vulnerability analysis fit architectural comparison, repository history, module boundaries, and alleged reuse versus independent development.

RELEVANT WORK

His public profile identifies research in software architecture description languages, architectural sustainability, software vulnerability detection, software modernization, and AI-assisted software engineering.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed USC profile and bounded public-web search did not identify a candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial record. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Strong architecture expertise does not itself supply state DMV, dealer-system, or title-compliance experience; current institutional and industry relationships require full conflicts review.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | neno@usc.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Dennis Shasha

Julius Silver Professor of Computer Science, New York University

TECHNICAL FIT

Database tuning, transaction design, data-system performance, and database experimentation fit fee-calculation tables, transaction histories, concurrency, auditability, and reproducible platform testing.

RELEVANT WORK

NYU identifies his research and consulting in database tuning and design; he has written books on database tuning and works across database, algorithmic, and data-intensive research problems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed NYU profile and bounded public-web search did not identify a candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial record. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public profile does not show motor-vehicle registration or modern dealer-platform implementation work, and database tuning is narrower than the full trade-secret and workflow questions.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | shasha@cs.nyu.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Adam Porter

Professor of Computer Science and UMIACS affiliate, University of Maryland

TECHNICAL FIT

Empirical software engineering, software testing, configuration testing, and test automation fit validation of fee engines, state-specific configurations, form versions, integration paths, and independent-development claims.

RELEVANT WORK

His public profile identifies empirically guided software development, software testing, configuration-space evaluation, and leadership in software-engineering research and test-automation work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The reviewed University of Maryland profile and bounded public-web search did not identify a candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial record. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Testing expertise may need to be paired with an enterprise architect and a motor-vehicle workflow specialist; his public materials do not show DMV domain experience.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | aporter@cs.umd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Mustaque Ahamad

SCP Interim Chair and USG Regents Entrepreneur Professor, Georgia Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Distributed systems, identity and access management, fraud detection, and secure service architecture fit platform access, authentication, audit logs, third-party integrations, and alleged acquisition pathways.

RELEVANT WORK

Former director of the Georgia Tech Information Security Center; his public profile identifies converged-network security, identity management, and distributed systems work. He co-founded Pindrop and serves as chief scientist.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record was located in the reviewed Georgia Tech sources and bounded public-web search. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Pindrop and other commercial relationships require close conflicts review; his subject-matter work is security-focused rather than automotive titling and fee compliance.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | mustaque.ahamad@cc.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Patrick Traynor

John and Mary Lou Dasburg Preeminent Chair and Professor, University of Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Applied security, mobile systems, authentication, telecommunications infrastructure, and fraud detection fit identity-provider integrations, security controls, access logs, and transaction-abuse analysis.

RELEVANT WORK

University of Florida sources describe research on mobile and telecommunications security, infrastructure vulnerabilities, authentication, applied cryptography, and methods to detect and combat caller-ID scams.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record was located in the reviewed University of Florida sources and bounded public-web search. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Security and abuse-detection expertise is not a substitute for DMV operations, database architecture, or source-code provenance analysis; a narrower security role may be appropriate.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | traynor@cise.ufl.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Stefan Savage

Professor of Computer Science and Engineering, University of California, San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Empirical security measurement, cybercrime, distributed systems, mobile and wireless security, and abuse ecosystems fit forensic reconstruction of platform access, downloads, communications, and anomalous transaction or account behavior.

RELEVANT WORK

His public profiles describe research on Internet security, spam and scam ecosystems, mobile and wireless security, and measurement-driven analysis of real-world abuse.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record was located in the reviewed UC San Diego sources and bounded public-web search. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His strongest fit is empirical security and abuse measurement, not vehicle-title rules, document generation, or enterprise application design.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | savage@cs.ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Steven M. Bellovin

Percy K. and Vida L. W. Hudson Professor Emeritus of Computer Science, Columbia University; Senior Affiliate Scholar, Georgetown Institute for Technology Law and Policy

TECHNICAL FIT

Security architecture, cryptography, authentication, telecommunications policy, privacy, and technology-law interfaces fit secrecy controls, logging, credential use, third-party access, and the explanation of technical controls to a court.

RELEVANT WORK

Former FTC Chief Technologist and longtime AT&T Bell Labs and AT&T Labs researcher; his public work spans network security, surveillance, privacy, Internet architecture, and technology policy.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record was located in the reviewed Columbia sources and bounded public-web search. This is not proof that he has never served; PACER and paid testimony databases were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Emeritus status and a broad security-policy profile make him less suited to current product teardown, dealership software, or state-form implementation without a complementary software expert.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | smb@cs.columbia.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74666375/1/dlrdmv-llc-v-lease-end-llc/>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://www.afslaw.com/print/pdf/node/18401>

Public technical context source: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74666375/1/dlrdmv-llc-v-lease-end-llc/>

LIMITATIONS

The complaint and public product materials frame the workflow categories, but they do not establish the final trade-secret definitions, source-code correspondence, alleged acquisition path, or causation. Any confidential trade-secret schedule, source code, repository history, logs, state-rule tables, integration specifications, and discovery responses must control the merits analysis.

No attorney or expert was contacted. No availability, interest, mailbox delivery, compensation, admissibility, retention suitability, or conflict determination has been made.